

TAB 23



Board of Education Report

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Agenda Date: 4/21/2026

In Control: Board of Education

Ms. Ortiz Franklin - LA Unified Commitment Day: Celebrating Postsecondary Pathways for All Students (Res-050-25/26) (Noticed March 10, 2026)

Whereas, The Governing Board of the Los Angeles Unified School District is committed to ensuring all students have the option to thrive in choose their college and career of choice;

Whereas, The Los Angeles Unified School District's Strategic Plan Pillar 1D College and Career Readiness highlights strategies to champion multiple pathways for college and career readiness for all students through engaging students and families at all levels, beginning in early grades, in college and career experiences and understanding promotion of postsecondary options;

Whereas, The Board set a goal to increase the percentage of students graduating demonstrating college and career readiness with a "C" or better on University of California/California State University A-G approved courses to seventy percent by June 2026 and is currently engaged in a process to finalize the June 2030 College/Career goal; students in targeted groups will demonstrate growth of twenty-five percentage points over time based on 2021-22 baseline data;

Whereas, In the 2024-2025 school year, 58.4% of all students in the graduating 9th-12th grade cohort demonstrated college and career readiness with a "C" or better on A-G approved courses;

Whereas, Equity gaps remain in the District's preparation for college access with 34.1% of students with disabilities, 34.7% of multilingual learners, 34.2% of students in foster youth, 56.2% of Latine students, and 53.7% of Black students in the cohort demonstrating college and career readiness with a "C" in A-G in 2024-2025;

Whereas, Michelle Obama launched National College Signing Day in 2014 as part of her Reach Higher initiative <<https://www.reachhigher.org/>> to celebrate all students committed to pursuing education past high school, including community college, a 4-year university, or a certificate from military or other professional training programs; with a greater focus on engaging Black and Brown students and students from historically under resourced communities;

Whereas, From 2021 through 2024, Board District 7 (BD7) hosted an annual College Signing Day (online in 2021, thereafter at California State University Dominguez Hills), where all BD7 families were invited and every high school senior in attendance came onstage to announced on stage their post-secondary college commitments to an audience full of fellow students, staff, and families and over 2,000 participants students and families engaged in a resource fair of over 50 university and community partners;

Whereas, College Signing Days celebrate graduating seniors who have made the commitment to continue their education in college and encourage early education through 11th grade students and

families to get excited and learn about college and career opportunities;

Whereas, Events like these are essential to promote college going, completion and early awareness, bridge equity gaps in access to information, opportunity and success in postsecondary education;

Whereas, In 2025, the District hosted a large-scale Commitment/College Signing Day celebration welcoming hundreds of graduating seniors and their families, featuring college and career booths, scholarship presentations, special guests, live entertainment, wellness resources and recognition of students' postsecondary commitments, demonstrating the power of districtwide celebration to uplift student achievement and expand access to opportunity; and

Whereas, In 2026 the District developed a College Signing Day Toolkit based on best practices to support and encourage schools to host their own College Signing Day on their school campus; now, therefore be it

Resolved, That the Governing Board of Education of the Los Angeles Unified School District reaffirms its commitment to creating a strong college-going and career-ready culture that promotes postsecondary access and completion, and elevates meaningful opportunities to recognize and celebrate students' postsecondary commitments through events such as College Signing Day;

Resolved further, That the Board encourages all high schools, inclusive of all instructional settings, to celebrate students' postsecondary commitments through hosting their own College Signing Day on their campus and to intentionally invite families and students from neighboring feeder early education centers, elementary and middle schools to cultivate early awareness in their community;

Resolved further, That early education, elementary and middle schools are encouraged to incorporate college and career activities aligned with Commitment Day celebrations, including attending Commitment Days at nearby high schools where possible, fostering a districtwide culture of postsecondary access, aspiration and success beginning in the early grades;

Resolved further, That the Superintendent shall designate an office to support districtwide implementation of Commitment Day celebrations, including developing, maintaining and distributing a Commitment Day toolkit, providing resources and assistance to schools, and sharing annual reporting on participation and best practices; and be it finally

Resolved, That the Board will annually recognize and celebrate college and postsecondary commitments at the May Board meeting through highlighting these Commitment/College Signing Day events through student testimonies, videos, or other forms of recognition that celebrate shine-light-on the success of LA Unified's graduating students.